

Guidelines for Performance Appraisals in Public Service



A joint exercise by Public Service Commission, National Salaries and Cadre Commission,
Ministry of Public Administration and Home Affairs, Ministry of Public Management
Reforms, Department of Management Services, Information and Communication
Technology Agency and Postgraduate Institute of Management
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This is a supplement to the Performance Appraisal System
(Attachment 1)

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Guidelines - Performance appraisals for public service

(Specific concern – staff grade)

1. Introduction

A. Performance appraisal is divided into two sections and percentage values are assigned to each section as follows

- | | | |
|-----------------|---|-----|
| a. Tasks | - | 80% |
| b. Competencies | - | 20% |

Total performance is calculated by adding up all the scores and will be marked out of 100.

The Classification of performance will be as follows

- | | | |
|---------------|---|----------------------------|
| 1. Above 100% | - | Exceptional |
| 2. 91% -100% | - | Excellent |
| 3. 81%-90% | - | Very Good |
| 4. 75%-80% | - | Above Average |
| 5. 71%-75% | - | Average |
| 6. 61%-70% | - | Satisfactory |
| 7. 51%-60% | - | Needs improvement |
| 8. Below 50 | - | Needs critical improvement |

Officers carrying excellent performance for 03 consecutive years will be given an additional increment. Officers carrying 3 such increments will be recognized for Presidential Awards for Governance and Public Administration.

Officers carrying two years below 50 will not get the increment until they reach the stage of satisfactory. It is the duty of the HR division to reach out to grade 8 performers and take corrective action in the second year itself. Training needs and other issues shall be identified by the HR division and required action should be taken within the period starting from 01 February to 1 June in a particular year.

B. Apart from these, there is another component to be matched **only** when and where it becomes genuinely mandatory

- a. Force majeure

- C. Performance plan is prepared by the HR division of each government entity in consultation with the officers concerned under the clear instructions of the head of the department.
- D. The process will involve the following
 - a. Design of performance plan
 - b. Mid-term evaluation
 - c. Year-end appraisal
- E. Three persons involved in the process are appraisee, appraiser and moderator while having the head of HR as the facilitator. For HR division the head of the state entity will monitor the process personally playing the role of head of HR in other instances.
- F. Appraiser will be the immediate supervising officer and the moderator will be the supervising officer of the previous supervising officer. When such three levels are absent, the head of HR will play the part of appraiser and head of the state entity will be the moderator.
- G. The decision of the head of entity will be final and can only be challenged by an appeal to the competent institution in charge of handling such appeals.

2. Performance Appraisals – Task based

- 2.1 Task based appraisal will carry 80% of the performance appraisal.
- 2.2 The impacts, outcomes, outputs and the activities required to deliver such required outputs will guide the process well.
- 2.3 Performance planning is done as per the following time table
- 2.4 Performance plan preparation and approval - from the date of passing the appropriation bill up to the first week of January
- 2.5 Midterm evaluation and feedback – from 1st July to 14th July
- 2.6 Yearend evaluation and feedback - from first week of January to the last week of January
- 2.7 All the major activities pertaining to the entity can be identified in the first place. Whenever a new assignment is received by the entities concerned the activities can be freshly identified and incorporated in the performance of the organization with identified specific activities
- 2.8 It is the said major activities that end up as key result areas (KRA) in performance planning and appraisals

- 2.9 In each KRA the tasks involved can be identified which may vary from one to many.
- 2.10 Each task will be prioritised and assigned a mark out of 100 upon the priority agreed by the appraiser and head of the department.
- 2.11 The marks allotted to each task should be 100 when added up after allocation.
- 2.12 Each task will have a task completion with a unit specification and time frame
- 2.13 A specified task completion is named Key Performance Indicator which should be designed with cost, quantity, quality and time factors in mind.
- 2.14 Key Performance Indicator will describe the annual target that each task entails in unit form
- 2.15 The Actual performance is the appraiser's achievement at the end of the year.
- 2.16 For midterm evaluation Actual performance is the achievement of the appraiser for the period considered i.e. from 1st January to 30 June.
- 2.17 Actual performance is always taken in terms of a percentage which is calculated by dividing the number achieved by the Key Performance Indicator and multiplying by 100.
- 2.18 The percentage Actual performance will be multiplied by the mark allocated to each task at the end to obtain scaled performance.
- 2.19 Key performance Indicator is considered the 100 mark benchmark.
- 2.20 Mark allocated to each task is multiplied by 100 to obtain the highest obtainable by the appraiser.
- 2.21 The actual performance is matched to the maximum obtainable by way of dividing the actual performance by the maximum obtainable and multiplied by 80 because this part (completion of tasks) constitutes only 80% of the whole performance appraisal.

3. Performance Appraisals – Competency based

- 3.1 A predefined format is introduced to measure competencies.
- 3.2 Competencies are measured in relation to Key Behavioural Indicators (KBI).
- 3.3 The generic format introduced may not be adequate given the nature of work and the demands of a specific designation concerned.
- 3.4 The format is one of Likert scale ranging from 0 -5
- 3.5 0 – poor, 1 – needs critical improvements, 2 – needs improvements, 3 – satisfactory, 4 – very good, 5 – excellent.

- 3.6 Competencies, for the purpose of this appraisal process, is defined as the mandatory personal attributes that an officer is required to develop in order to perform the tasks at the maximum best.
- 3.7 The competencies to be measured are agreed by the appraisee, appraiser and moderator at the beginning of the year assisted by the HR division.
- 3.8 Evaluation may be done by the appraiser and peers as well as juniors as it may be necessary.
- 3.9 The midterm evaluation will serve the purpose of feedback only and the genuine feedback is expected from appraiser, peers and juniors.
- 3.10 At the final appraisal of competencies the appraiser and/or moderator may either choose to look for peer and junior reviews or decide on his own. Whatever the method he uses, it shall be informed to the appraisee concerned.
- 3.11 The achievement is calculated by adding up all the marks against each attribute.
- 3.12 The maximum obtainable is calculated by multiplying the number of attributes by 5 which is the maximum obtainable in each attribute.
- 3.13 The overall achievement is matched to the maximum obtainable by dividing the overall achievement in competencies to the maximum obtainable and multiplying by 20 because this part (completion of tasks) constitutes only 20% of the whole performance appraisal.

4. Force majeure

Force Majeure is a moderating mechanism that makes room for the appraisee, appraiser and Moderator to sit together and evaluate the circumstances that has led to performance being low. It should follow a performance appraisal and will not precede. The consultations shall be made by the moderator and appraiser with the appraisee having the HR division head in attendance. The justifications should be detailed in such length that it should accommodate all impediments to performance met by the appraisee and the various measures he had taken, in his capacity, to overcome the impediments. The final decision should be taken only by the department head and this mechanism shall not be adopted except for ample justifications from the appraisee. Force Majeure is applicable to natural and national disaster situations and financial constraints met due to imprest shortages.

Whatever the identification and recognition of Force Majeure, the particular, grading he achieved can be adjusted **only** by one grade from the already earned grade by the Head of the state entity.

5. Appeal Procedure (Grievance handling)

- 5.1 An officer aggrieved by a final appraisal of a particular year can appeal to the competent institution formulated to entertain such appeal within a period of 04 weeks from the date of being informed of the final appraisal.
- 5.2 Such appeal should be supported amply by the appellant with all supportive documents and reasons why the final appraisal is not fair should be well articulated.
- 5.3 The Institution handling appeals can call for any material pertaining to such appeal from the head of state entity and also call for observations and recommendations from the state entity concerned.
- 5.4 Whatever the recommendation may be, the institution handling appeals will make its own judgement having looked into the matters produced.
- 5.5 The decision of the institution, handling appeals, will be final.

6. Responsibilities of the HR division

- 6.1 The whole process from performance planning to performance appraisal and the performance cycle will be the responsibility of the HR division
- 6.2 Manning of HR division is the responsibility of the head of the entity concerned.
- 6.3 Objectivity and confidentiality shall be a part of the work ethic.
- 6.4 After final appraisals are made, the HR division shall submit the results and the final appraisal forms along with other relevant documents to the administration division for payment of salary increments.
- 6.5 Reports to be prepared by the Division
 - 6.5.1. Appraisal Completion report
 - 6.5.2. Statistical analysis of performance pertaining single appraisee
 - 6.5.3. Statistical analysis of overall performance of all appraisees in tandem
 - 6.5.4. The output of the institution as a result of all appraisees

6.5.5. Individual performance contribution to the whole output of the entity

6.5.6. Performance distribution analysis

6.5.7. Training needs analysis and training needs identification report